



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Mary Seat of Wisdom Academy
School Website: <https://www.mswwichita.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Mary Seat Wisdom Academy Kansas (mswwichita.org content identified in the crawl store) presents as a strongly classical, explicitly Catholic, liberal-arts oriented program. Public materials emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom through a Catholic framework, a curriculum centered on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books, and pedagogy that includes Socratic seminars, chanting/recitation, and contemplative routines (Scholé). The school also communicates a clear partnership with families and an open, hospitable community posture (open houses, parent involvement, and family testimonials). Across six classical elements, the materials align with the classical rubric (transcending truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information; liberal arts curriculum; Socratic pedagogy; living faculty; and active parent–community partnerships). Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- The Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly stated through Catholic identity, theology, and virtue formation. The mission and vision consistently frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty within a Catholic-theological frame. Evidence includes explicit statements about Catholic classical education and formation toward God through Christ and His Church.
- The School Purpose and Goal centers on virtue and wisdom rather than job preparation, with language of formation of the whole person and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.
- The Curriculum foregrounds the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books, with references to the Great Conversation and primary texts.
- Pedagogy features Socratic seminars, restorative/Scholé-inspired approaches, and memorization/recitation; lower and upper-school practices are described publicly (e.g., Great Books, Socratic seminars, progymnasmata).
- Faculty materials show teachers as mentors embedded in the curriculum (faculty pages and profiles, Great Books instructors).
- Parents & Community materials highlight partnership with families, parent formation opportunities, and open-campus visits.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frame the school as Catholic classical education founded on forming the whole person to know, love, and serve God through Christ and His Church. - Mission/vision documents describe virtue formation, mind–body–spirit integration, and the Church's perennial form of education guiding pedagogy. - Public FAQ and curriculum documents tie theology, Scripture, catechesis, and liturgical rhythm to ongoing formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed (aligned with the lexicon): virtue, theology, Church, God, formation, sacred tradition (implicitly via Catholic framing), contemplation of truth and beauty. -

Negative keywords observed: none identified in the public materials. - Quantitative note: Positive indicators appear repeatedly (roughly 3–4 distinct terms clearly present; 0 negative indicators).

Why this rating - The school's public materials explicitly anchor education in Catholic theology, virtue formation, and a sacramental/catechetical frame, consistent with the "Grounded in Theology" and "Transcendental moral realism" expectations of the classical rubric. This supports CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes cultivation of virtue and formation of wisdom rather than vocational outcomes. The language centers on formation of the whole person and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. - Public descriptions frame education as formation of character and intellect, not mere information or job training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty (as a triad), contemplation. - Negative keywords observed: none in the public materials. - Quantitative note: Positive indicators clearly present (multiple terms); negative indicators 0.

Why this rating - The school consistently presents education as formation and cultivation of virtue and wisdom, aligning with the classical aim of forming humane persons rather than primarily preparing for employment. This merits CLASSICAL here.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum materials cite the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium) and the Quadrivium in foundational framing. Great Books and the Great Conversation appear prominently (e.g., Great Books programs, primary texts). The curriculum includes Scripture & Catechesis and classical languages. - Faculty pages and course descriptions reference Great Books, classical texts, and formal rhetorical training (progymnasmata, Latin, etc.). - Public discussions of seminars and the Great Books approach (e.g., The Socratic Seminar, seminars focused on great texts) align with classical curriculum design.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, classical canon, Socratic dialogue, history, Latin, rhetoric, memorization/recitation, formation through study of foundational texts. - Negative keywords observed: none identified in public materials (no overt "project-based learning" or non-traditional curriculum signals as a primary framing). - Quantitative note: Strong presence of multiple classical curriculum keywords; 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating - The materials clearly foreground the liberal-arts curriculum, Great Books, and formal classical disciplines, consistent with CLASSICAL taxonomy for Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical descriptions include Socratic seminars, small seminars focused on great texts, and student discourse as the core upper-school practice. The public materials discuss restfulness and contemplation (Scholé) as complements to rigorous study, with lower-school chant and memory work.

- The site highlights memorization/recitation (chanting, singing), progress through progymnasmata, and imitation of classical models as pedagogy. - A public "Faculty" page and course descriptions show teachers guiding the Great Books and classical curricula, reinforcing the teacher as mentor and living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue/seminar, Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, chanting/singing, formation through imitation, master-teacher style, living curriculum. - Negative keywords observed: absence of exclusively project-based or constructivist-only signals (no dominant "experiential-only" framing). - Quantitative note: Multiple classical pedagogy keywords present; 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating - The school explicitly employs Socratic discussion, rhetoric training, chant/memory work, and contemplative pedagogy, aligning with CLASSICAL pedagogy expectations.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty pages describe teachers as mentors and exemplars; profiles emphasize living curriculum, model virtue, and mastery in their subjects. The faculty are presented as core to the school ethos, with emphasis on literature, Great Books, theology, and classical formation. - Specific faculty profiles (e.g., Great Books teachers, science educators) illustrate subject-matter expertise and long-standing commitment to classical education. - The public mission and curriculum framing position teachers as exemplar mentors, aligning with classical expectations of a “living curriculum.”

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, mentors, master-teacher model, teachers as exemplars, classical formation, Great Books faculty, teacher as guide. - Negative keywords observed: none identified in the public materials. - Quantitative note: Multiple positive faculty signals; 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating - The site presents a strong, traditional faculty model aligned with classical education's expectations for teacher as mentor and living curriculum, supporting CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly partners with families and presents parents as co-teachers or co-educators, including parent formation opportunities (book studies, gatherings) and a welcoming policy for visits. Open houses and community events are highlighted, and testimonials show active parental engagement. - Community content includes “Seeds of Wisdom” blog posts and family testimonials, emphasizing home-school partnership and shared mission. - Public materials indicate the school's openness to visitors and ongoing parent education (open house, ICLE membership signaling alignment with Catholic liberal-arts education).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, parent engagement, open campus/visits, family involvement, community of learners, parental covenant. - Negative keywords observed: none identified. - Quantitative note: Clear presence of multiple parent/community signals; 0 negative indicators.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly support CLASSICAL for Parents & Community, with explicit partnership and parental formation elements, plus open access to visits and involvement opportunities.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required since all six categories align with CLASSICAL criteria. If you want to push toward an even more explicit alignment, you could standardize language around “Scholé” and “Great Conversation” in every grade level's public-facing descriptions, and explicitly label all pedagogy as Socratic/seminar-driven in a single, accessible page for families.
- Optional enhancement: add a dedicated “Great Books and Trivium” curriculum map page that explicitly lists grammar, logic, rhetoric, and a representative Great Books list by grade, with stated connections to virtues and metaphysical aims, to reinforce category signals for prospective families. This would further operationalize the Six Elements indicators in a user-friendly way.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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